Project Report: Back-to-School Drive 2023

Reference: ADA/2023/004 **Period:** August 1 – December 31, 2023 **Location:** Bamenda & surrounding villages, North-West Region, Cameroon **Organization:** Apoti Development Association (ADA)

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1. Executive Summary

ADA's first Back-to-School Drive in Bamenda successfully enrolled 20 orphaned children in 4 local schools for the 2023–2024 academic year. All children received full tuition coverage, uniforms, and school supplies. The project achieved a 100% retention rate, and all 20 children passed their end-of-year examinations.

The project was delivered under budget at 940,000 CFA ($1,567 USD) against a planned 960,000 CFA ($1,600 USD), with savings from partial tuition coverage provided by a local church for 2 beneficiaries.

2. Context

The ongoing Anglophone crisis in Cameroon's North-West Region has displaced thousands of families, leaving many children—especially orphans—without access to education. Bamenda and its surrounding villages have been particularly affected. ADA previously conducted back-to-school drives only in Buea; this project represents the first expansion into the North-West Region.

3. Objectives & Achievement

Objective	Target	Achieved
Children enrolled	20	20 ✓
Retention rate	100%	100% ✓
School partnerships	4	4 ✓
End-of-year pass rate	100%	100% ✓

4. Activities Completed

4.1 Beneficiary Identification (August 2023)

- Partnered with 2 local community leaders to identify orphaned children across Bamenda and surrounding villages
- Verified eligibility of 20 children based on orphan status, displacement, and inability to access education
- Prioritized the most vulnerable cases

4.2 School Enrollment & Tuition Payment (August–September 2023)

- Registered 20 children across 4 partner schools
- Paid tuition fees for all 20 children (average 25,000 CFA per child)
- 2 children received partial tuition coverage from a local church, reducing ADA's contribution

4.3 Uniform & Supplies Distribution (September 2023)

- Provided complete school uniforms to all 20 children
- Distributed school supplies and books (notebooks, pens, textbooks)

4.4 Monitoring & Support (October–December 2023)

- Conducted multiple village visits to monitor attendance and well-being
- Coordinated with school administrators on academic progress
- Maintained communication with community leaders for ongoing support

5. Outcomes & Impact

- **20 orphaned children** gained access to education for the full academic year
- **100% retention rate** — no dropouts recorded
- **100% pass rate** — all children passed end-of-year examinations
- **4 school partnerships** established for ongoing collaboration
- **Community trust built** — local leaders actively engaged in identification and monitoring
- **Model validated** — Bamenda expansion proved successful, enabling future drives in the region

6. Challenges & Lessons Learned

Challenge	Response
Displacement made some families hard to locate	Community leaders provided critical local knowledge
Transport to remote villages was time-intensive	Multiple coordinated visits reduced individual trip costs
Security concerns in some areas	Worked through trusted local networks

Key Lessons

1. **Community leader partnerships are essential** — local knowledge enabled accurate beneficiary identification
2. **Church partnerships can supplement funding** — 2 children's tuition was partially covered, creating a model for co-funding
3. **Early enrollment is critical** — starting in August ensured children didn't miss the school year opening

7. Financial Summary

Item	Budget (CFA)	Actual (CFA)
Tuition fees	500,000	480,000
School uniforms	300,000	300,000
School supplies/books	100,000	100,000
Transport/coordination	40,000	40,000
Communication	10,000	10,000
Contingency	10,000	10,000
Total	**960,000**	**940,000**

Variance: 20,000 CFA under budget (2 children's tuition partially covered by church)

8. Sustainability

- School partnerships remain active for future academic years
- Community leader network established for ongoing beneficiary identification
- Model can be replicated in additional villages
- Church co-funding relationship established

9. Recommendations

1. **Scale the Bamenda drive** — expand to 30+ children in 2024 given successful model
2. **Formalize church partnerships** — develop co-funding agreements for sustainability
3. **Add mid-year check-ins** — structured academic progress reviews at term breaks
4. **Document beneficiary stories** — for reporting and awareness purposes

10. Conclusion

The Back-to-School Drive 2023 in Bamenda achieved all stated objectives, demonstrating that ADA's education support model can be successfully expanded beyond Buea. The combination of community leader partnerships, school cooperation, and comprehensive support (tuition + uniforms + supplies + monitoring) proved effective in ensuring enrollment, retention, and academic success for 20 vulnerable children.

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